Such lack of engagement from the youth can be explained by exploring Ryan's (2011) research that draws on the work of Henri Lefebvre, conceptualizing the importance of 'lived space' in the day-to-day lives of young students, and their expression of resistance and activism. For Ryan (2011) 'lived space is a space to resist, subvert and re-imagine', creating 'new possibilities and imaginings of how things could be, a space of transgression and symbolism' (Ryan 2011, p. 1021). The 'space' a student has to be politically active or engaged is defined at different levels of 'perceived, conceived and lived spaces of representation' (Ryan 2011, p. 1019 discussing Henri Lefebvre 1991), where all these levels intersect with each other in defining/confining the space for political thought or action for young students. The question of why some students are politically active and others are not can also be linked to perceptions of space, but may also be influenced by other indicators. Braungart (1971) in his study links the nature of student activism and protest to socialization through one's family, where 'family politics, argumentation, religion, and social class' all 'affected student political identification' (p. 127). In the case of Pakistan though, Lall (2012) has argued that while 'family' or 'school' are both important, other factors such as ethnicity, religious ideology and class may also become important factors in determining the nature of political activism.

The Pakistani case becomes problematic where historically the student political activist occupies an important 'space' within the Pakistan movement. Yet the patronage of student political groups by political parties, and by the military, with violence dominating the 'space' of political activism especially in the 1980s and 1990s, the activist, far from upholding democratic principles and values, often became a tool of political repression within university campuses. The next section highlights this evolution of the student activist, and provides a context to the narratives of nonpolitical or apolitical youth in this study who have become disillusioned by the corruption and violence of the student political activist.

The Pakistani student political activist

The role of the student political activist was clearly defined in a speech by Muhammad Ali Jinnah at the Muslim University Union, Aligarh, on 2 November 1941: 'I am not going to repeat hackneyed phrases like the youth of today will be the leaders of tomorrow. But as a practical man I tell you that great responsibility rests on you. The youth will have to bear the brunt of the struggle in the very near future' (as quoted in Mirza 1989, p. 147). The All India Muslim Students' Federation (AIMSF) was established in 1937. In its initial years the AIMSF faced